NATIONAL BUILDERS CORP

MONTHLY PROGRESS TRACKER

"Stay on Track"

Complete 10-Page Check-In Tool | Ages 7-17 | 2025 Edition

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INTRODUCTION: WHY MONTHLY CHECK-INS MATTER

Welcome to Your Progress Tracker!

This workbook helps you stay on track during your 6-month project journey (May-October).

Why monthly check-ins are important:

✅**ACCOUNTABILITY** - You commit to making progress each month

✅**COURSE CORRECTION** - Catch problems early before they become big

✅**DOCUMENTATION** - Record your journey for the final report

✅**MOTIVATION** - See your progress, celebrate wins

✅**LEARNING** - Reflect on what's working and what's not

What Happens If You Don't Track Progress?

Many projects fail because:

- Teams lose momentum after the first month
- Small problems become big crises
- No one remembers what they did (poor documentation)
- Team members disagree about who did what
- October arrives and there's nothing to report

Don't let this happen to you!

Monthly check-ins take only 30-60 minutes but keep your project alive.

HOW TO USE THIS TRACKER

WHEN TO COMPLETE

Last week of each month:

- May 24-31
- June 24-30
- July 24-31
- August 24-31
- September 24-30
- October 24-31

WHO COMPLETES IT

Option 1: Team leader fills it out based on team discussion

Option 2: Each team member answers individually, then combine

Option 3: Fill it out together during team meeting

Recommendation: Option 3 (fill out together) - ensures everyone agrees on what happened.

WHAT TO DO WITH COMPLETED FORMS

1. **Take a photo** of each completed form
2. **Send to your regional coordinator** via WhatsApp
3. **Keep the original** in a safe place
4. **Use it** when writing your final report in October

SUBMISSION DEADLINE

By the 5th of the following month:

- May report: Due June 5
- June report: Due July 5
- July report: Due August 5
- August report: Due September 5
- September report: Due October 5
- October report: Due October 31 (with final submission)

Note: You can also submit via the NBC website at KidsInspiringNation.org/submit

MONTHLY REPORT TEMPLATE

Copy this template 6 times (once for each month May-October)

NATIONAL BUILDERS CORP

MONTHLY PROGRESS REPORT

TEAM/INDIVIDUAL NAME: _____

PROJECT TITLE: _____

MONTH: ☐ May ☐ June ☐ July ☐ August ☐ September ☐ October

DATE SUBMITTED: _____

SECTION 1: WHAT DID YOU DO THIS MONTH?

List your main activities (bullet points):

Activity 1:

_____

_____

Activity 2:

_____

_____

Activity 3:

_____

_____

Activity 4:

_____

_____

Activity 5:

_____

_____

(Add more if needed)

SECTION 2: WHAT WORKED WELL?

What successes did you have this month? What went better than expected?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Why did these things work well?

_____

_____

_____

SECTION 3: WHAT PROBLEMS DID YOU FACE?

Be honest. Every project has challenges.

Challenge 1:

_____

_____

How did you handle it?

_____

_____

Is it resolved or ongoing? ☐ Resolved ☐ Still working on it

Challenge 2:

_____

_____

How did you handle it?

_____

_____

Is it resolved or ongoing? ☐ Resolved ☐ Still working on it

Challenge 3:

_____

_____

How did you handle it?

_____

_____

Is it resolved or ongoing? ☐ Resolved ☐ Still working on it

SECTION 4: IMPACT THIS MONTH

How many people did you help/serve this month?

Number: _____

Who were they? (describe the people)

_____

_____

How did you help them? (be specific)

_____

_____

_____

Tell us ONE story:

Choose one person whose life was impacted. What's their story?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Their quote (if possible, ask them to say something in their own words):

*"_____

_____

_____"*

— Name: _____

SECTION 5: VALUES IN ACTION

Which of the 8 National Builder values guided you this month?

Pick 2-3 values and give specific examples of how you demonstrated them:

Value 1: _____

How I/we showed it:

_____

_____

_____

Value 2: _____

How I/we showed it:

_____

_____

_____

Value 3: _____

How I/we showed it:

_____

_____

_____

SECTION 6: RESOURCES USED THIS MONTH

Money spent: ₦_____

What you spent it on:

_____

_____

_____

Materials/supplies received:

_____

_____

Volunteer hours contributed:

_____

In-kind donations received:

_____

_____

SECTION 7: DOCUMENTATION

Number of photos taken this month: _____

Number of videos recorded: _____

Have you sent photos to your coordinator? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

Photo highlights: (Describe your 3 best photos)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

SECTION 8: NEXT MONTH'S PLAN

What are your main goals for next month?

Goal 1:

_____

_____

Goal 2:

_____

_____

Goal 3:

_____

_____

What help do you need?

_____

_____

_____

Any questions for your coordinator?

_____

_____

_____

SECTION 9: TEAM REFLECTION

(If working as a team)

How is your team working together?

☐ Excellent - everyone contributing equally

☐ Good - minor issues but we're managing

☐ Fair - some team members not pulling their weight

☐ Poor - serious team conflicts

If not excellent, what's the issue?

_____

_____

What will you do about it?

_____

_____

SECTION 10: MENTOR CHECK-IN

Did your mentor visit/check on you this month?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, what feedback did they give?

_____

_____

_____

If no, when is your next meeting with them?

_____

SECTION 11: OVERALL PROJECT STATUS

How would you rate your progress this month?

☐ Excellent - ahead of schedule

☐ Good - on track

☐ Fair - a bit behind but catching up

☐ Poor - significantly behind schedule

Are you on track to finish by October?

☐ Yes, definitely

☐ Yes, if we work hard

☐ Maybe, but worried

☐ No, we need help

If you're behind, what's your plan to catch up?

_____

_____

_____

SIGNATURES

Team Leader: _____ **Date:** _____

Mentor (if available): _____ **Date:** _____

SUBMIT THIS FORM TO YOUR REGIONAL COORDINATOR BY THE 5TH OF NEXT MONTH

WhatsApp: [Coordinator Number]

Website: KidsInspiringNation.org/submit

Email: [Coordinator Email]

End of Monthly Report Template

PHOTO DOCUMENTATION GUIDE

WHY PHOTOS MATTER

Photos are your PROOF that:

- The problem exists
- You did the work
- You made an impact
- Real people benefited

Without photos, your project story is much weaker.

WHAT TO PHOTOGRAPH

EVERY MONTH, TAKE PHOTOS OF:

✅**Your team working** (show action, not just posing)

✅**The people you're helping** (with their permission)

✅**Before/during/after** of the problem being solved

✅**Materials and resources** you're using

✅**Community members participating**

✅**Any challenges** you're facing

✅**Small wins and milestones**

PHOTO TIPS FOR SMARTPHONES

1. LIGHTING:

- Shoot during daytime when possible
- Avoid harsh midday sun (early morning or late afternoon is best)
- If indoors, stand near windows

2. COMPOSITION:

- Get close to your subject
- Include people's faces (shows human impact)
- Show context (where is this happening?)
- Take multiple shots of the same thing

3. TECHNICAL:

- Hold phone steady (lean against something if needed)
- Clean your camera lens before shooting
- Use the gridlines on your camera to center subjects
- Don't use digital zoom (step closer instead)

4. STORYTELLING:

- Capture emotions (smiles, concentration, teamwork)

- Show the scale (how big is the problem/solution?)
- Document the process, not just the result

HOW MANY PHOTOS?

Minimum: 10 photos per month

Recommended: 20-30 photos per month

Best practice: Take 50+ photos, choose the best 20

PHOTO STORAGE

Organize your photos by month:

Create folders:

- □ NBC_Project_May_2025
- □ NBC_Project_June_2025
- □ NBC_Project_July_2025
- etc.

Backup your photos:

- Upload to Google Drive/OneDrive
- Send to mentor
- Keep on multiple devices

Don't lose your photos! They're essential for your final report.

GETTING PERMISSION

Before photographing people:

1. Explain you're doing a National Builders project
2. Ask: "May I take your photo to show the impact of our work?"
3. If they say no, respect it
4. For children, ask parents/teachers first

PHOTO CAPTIONS

For each photo, write a brief caption:

Format:

"[What's happening] in [location], [date]. [Impact/significance]."

Example:

"Ada teaching 10 children to read at Mushin Primary School, June 15, 2025. These children have improved their reading by 2 grade levels in one month."

TEAM REFLECTION QUESTIONS

MONTHLY TEAM MEETING DISCUSSION

(Use these questions during your monthly team meetings)

PROGRESS CHECK

1. Are we on track with our timeline?

☐ Yes - ahead of schedule

☐ Yes - right on schedule

☐ No - slightly behind

☐ No - significantly behind

If behind, why?

_____

What will we do differently next month?

_____

---

2. Is everyone contributing equally?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If no, who needs to step up?

_____

How will we address this?

_____

---

3. Are we using our resources wisely?

☐ Yes

☐ No - we're wasting resources

☐ No - we need more resources

Explain:

_____

IMPACT CHECK

4. Are we actually helping people, or just doing activities?

☐ We're making real impact

☐ We're doing activities but not sure about impact yet

☐ We're not seeing impact yet

What evidence do we have of impact?

_____

5. What do the people we're serving say about our project?

_____

_____

VALUES CHECK

6. Which value did we demonstrate well this month?

_____

Example:

_____

7. Which value did we struggle with?

_____

Why?

_____

How can we improve?

_____

LEARNING CHECK

8. What did we learn this month?

_____

_____

_____

9. What would we do differently if we could start this month over?

_____

_____

_____

RELATIONSHIP CHECK

10. How is our team working together?

☐ Great - we communicate well and support each other

☐ Good - minor disagreements but we work through them

☐ Fair - some tension but we're managing

☐ Poor - serious conflicts affecting our work

If not great, what's the specific issue?

_____

How will we resolve it?

_____

11. How is our relationship with the community?

☐ Excellent - they trust us and participate actively

☐ Good - they're supportive

☐ Fair - some skepticism but warming up

☐ Poor - they don't trust us or participate

If not excellent, how can we build better relationships?

_____

_____

12. Are we working well with our mentor?

☐ Yes - they're very helpful

☐ Somewhat - they could be more involved

☐ No - we rarely hear from them

☐ We don't have a mentor yet

If issues, what will we do?

_____

PROBLEM-SOLVING WHEN YOU'RE STUCK

COMMON PROBLEMS & SOLUTIONS

PROBLEM 1: We're running out of money

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Get creative with free/cheap alternatives**

What can you use that costs nothing?

☐ **Ask for in-kind donations**

What can people donate (services, materials) instead of money?

☐ **Organize a small fundraiser**

What can you sell or do to raise ₦5,000-10,000?

☐ **Simplify your approach**

What's the minimum version that still works?

☐ **Partner with a local business**

What business might sponsor you for publicity?

PROBLEM 2: Team members aren't showing up

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Have a direct conversation**

"We need you. What's stopping you from participating?"

☐ **Adjust meeting times**

Maybe the schedule doesn't work for everyone?

☐ **Clarify expectations**

Does everyone know what's expected of them?

☐ **Make it more engaging**

Is the work boring? How can you make it fun?

☐ **Last resort: Replace them**

If they won't commit, find someone who will

PROBLEM 3: The community isn't participating

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Ask them why**

"What would make you more interested in this project?"

☐ **Involve them in planning**

Did you design this FOR them or WITH them?

☐ **Show early wins**

Even small successes can build momentum

☐ **Find a community champion**

One respected person can influence many others

☐ **Address their concerns**

Are they worried about something?

PROBLEM 4: Our solution isn't working

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Diagnose the problem**

What specifically isn't working? Why?

☐ **Ask for expert advice**

Who has solved this problem before?

☐ **Test a different approach**

What's Plan B?

☐ **Adjust expectations**

Maybe you need to solve a smaller piece first?

☐ **Learn and pivot**

It's okay to change your strategy

PROBLEM 5: We're exhausted and want to quit

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Take a short break**

Rest for a few days, then return refreshed

☐ **Remember your WHY**

Why did you start this? Read your Values Commitment

☐ **Celebrate what you've done**

Don't focus only on what's left

☐ **Ask for help**

Call your mentor or coordinator

☐ **Adjust the pace**

Maybe you're trying to do too much too fast?

☐ **Lean on your team**

Talk about how everyone is feeling

PROBLEM 6: We have a conflict in the team

SOLUTIONS:

☐ **Address it immediately**

Don't let resentment build

☐ **Have a team meeting with ground rules:**

- Everyone gets to speak
- Listen without interrupting
- Focus on the problem, not the person
- Find a solution together

☐ **Get a mediator**

Ask your mentor to help facilitate

☐ **Clarify roles**

Sometimes conflict comes from confusion about who does what

☐ **Practice the value of HUMILITY**

Apologize if you were wrong. Forgive if others were.

WHEN TO ASK FOR HELP

Contact your regional coordinator if:

☐ You're stuck and can't figure out what to do

☐ You haven't made progress in 2 weeks

☐ Team conflict is affecting the project

☐ You need resources you can't get

☐ Community is hostile to your project

☐ Safety concerns arise

☐ You're considering quitting

Don't suffer in silence. NBC is here to support you!

CELEBRATING SMALL WINS

WHY CELEBRATION MATTERS

Projects are HARD. If you only celebrate at the end, you'll lose motivation.

Celebrate small wins along the way!

WHAT TO CELEBRATE

EVERY MONTH, celebrate:

✅Completing a major milestone

✅First person/family helped

✅Overcoming a big challenge

✅Receiving a donation or partnership

✅Positive community feedback

✅Learning a new skill

✅Staying consistent (worked every week)

✅Good teamwork moments

HOW TO CELEBRATE

Free celebrations:

- Team high-fives or group hug
- Take a fun team photo
- Share your win on social media
- Thank each other verbally
- Write down the win in your journal

Low-cost celebrations:

- Share snacks together (₦500)
- Team outing to a local spot (₦1,000-2,000)
- Make certificates for each other
- Create a "Wins Wall" with photos

Remember: Celebration fuels motivation for next month!

MONTHLY WINS LOG

Copy this for each month:

MONTH: _____

OUR WINS THIS MONTH:

Win 1: _____

Win 2: _____

Win 3: _____

How we celebrated:

_____

Team member who deserves special recognition:

_____

Why:

_____

PROGRESS SUMMARY SHEET

6-MONTH OVERVIEW

(Fill this out in October when completing your final report)

PROJECT START DATE: _____

PROJECT END DATE: _____

TOTAL DURATION: _____

QUANTITATIVE SUMMARY

Total people directly helped: _____

Total people indirectly impacted: _____

Total volunteer hours contributed: _____

Total money spent: ₦_____

Total in-kind donations received: ₦_____

Number of team members: _____

Number of community volunteers involved: _____

Number of monthly reports submitted: _____

Number of photos taken: _____

Number of videos created: _____

QUALITATIVE SUMMARY

Biggest success:

_____

_____

_____

Biggest challenge:

_____

_____

How we overcame it:

_____

_____

Most important thing we learned:

_____

_____

_____

How this project changed us personally:

_____

_____

_____

What we would do differently if starting over:

_____

_____

_____

Why we're proud of this project:

_____

_____

_____

SUSTAINABILITY STATUS

Is this project continuing after October?

☐ Yes

☐ No

☐ Partially

If yes, who is taking it over?

_____

What support do they need?

_____

_____

Congratulations on completing 6 months of nation-building work!

Now compile this summary into your Final Impact Report (Workbook 4).

END OF MONTHLY PROGRESS TRACKER

Remember:

- Complete your monthly report by the 5th of each month
- Take photos EVERY time you work
- Celebrate small wins
- Ask for help when stuck
- Stay consistent - that's the key to success!

For more resources and support, visit:

 Website: KidsInspiringNation.org

 WhatsApp: [Coordinator Number]

 Email: KidsInspiringNation@gmail.com

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